Hikaru Asano

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Education

The University of Tokyo Apr 2024 – Present
Doctoral Student in Graduate School of Arts and Sciences
- *Supervisor:* Yukino Baba

The University of Tokyo Apr 2022 – Mar 2024
Master of Interdisciplinary Information Studies in Graduate School of Interdisciplinary Information Studies
- *Supervisor:* Osamu Sakura

The University of Tokyo Apr 2019 – Mar 2022
Bachelor of Engineering in Systems Innovation, Faculty of Engineering
- *Supervisor:* Takashi Goda

Research Experience

Sakana AI, Tokyo, Japan Apr 2026 – Present
Research Intern

Omron SINIC X Corporation, Tokyo, Japan Dec 2025 – Mar 2026
Research Intern

CyberAgent AI Lab, Tokyo, Japan Oct 2023 – Oct 2025
Part-time Researcher

OMRON SINIC X Corporation, Tokyo, Japan Mar 2022 – Aug 2023
Research Intern

OMRON SINIC X Corporation, Tokyo, Japan Aug 2020 – Sep 2020
Research Intern

Publications

International Conference (Peer-Reviewed)

- **Hikaru Asano**, Hidezo Suganuma, Ryutaro Mori, Yukino Baba
  "Cross-Centaur: Modeling Individual Decision-Making Across Psychological Tasks with Language Models"
  The 2026 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing **(EMNLP)**, 2026
  Acceptance rate: 15.4%
  arXiv
- **Hikaru Asano**, Hiroki Ouchi, Akira Kasuga, Ryo Yonetani
  "MobQA: A Benchmark Dataset for Semantic Understanding of Human Mobility Data through Question Answering"
  The 2026 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing **(EMNLP)**, 2026
  Acceptance rate: 15.4%
  arXiv Code
- **Hikaru Asano**, Tadashi Kozuno, Yukino Baba
  "Self Iterative Label Refinement via Robust Unlabeled Learning"
  The Thirty-Ninth Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems **(NeurIPS)**, 2025
  Poster presentation | Acceptance rate: 24.5%
  arXiv Code
- **Hikaru Asano**, Hiroki Ouchi, Taiki Sekii, Ryo Yonetani
  "Text2Traj2Text: Learning-by-Synthesis Framework for Contextual Captioning of Human Movement Trajectories"

International Natural Language Generation Conference **(INLG)**, 2024
Long paper
arXiv Code

- Eiko Matsuda, **Hikaru Asano**, Tomoyuki Yuzawa, Osamu Sakura
"Quantitative and Qualitative Analyses on Child's Animate Tendency"
Cognitive feelings: Towards multi-disciplinary approaches for realizing artificial systems with cognitive capacities **(ALIFE 2023 workshop)**, 2023
- **Hikaru Asano**, Osamu Sakura
"Rashomon Bound Regression: a Reproducible and Explorable Method for Regression-Based Analysis"
International Conference on Computational Social Science **(IC2S2)**, 2023
Poster presentation
- **Hikaru Asano**, Ryo Yonetani, Mai Nishimura, Tadashi Kozuno
"Counterfactual Fairness Filter for Fair-Delay Multi-Robot Navigation"
International Conference on Autonomous Agents and Multi-Agent Systems **(AAMAS)**, 2023
Oral presentation | Acceptance rate: 23.3%
arXiv Code

Preprint

- **Hikaru Asano**, Yotaro Kubo, So Kuroki
"Training-Free Pronunciation Transcription via Text-Constrained Acoustic Rescoring"
arXiv preprint, 2026
arXiv
- Manato Yaguchi, Yotaro Kubo, **Hikaru Asano**, So Kuroki
"Learning Natural Conversational Behavior in Tandem Speech-to-Speech Models with Randomized Guidance"
arXiv preprint, 2026
arXiv
- **Hikaru Asano**, Tadashi Kozuno, Kuniaki Saito, Yukino Baba
"Where-to-Unmask: Ground-Truth-Guided Unmasking Order Learning for Masked Diffusion Language Models"
arXiv preprint, 2026
arXiv
- **Hikaru Asano**
"Sequential Bayesian experimental designs via reinforcement learning"
arXiv preprint, 2022
arXiv

Patent

- Ryo Yonetani, Mai Nishimura Kurose, **Hikaru Asano**
"Agent Control Device, Learning Device, and Computer-Readable Recording Medium"
US Patent App. 18/241,146

Awards and Honors

Scholarships and Grants

- **KAKUSEI Project by AIST**
3,000,000 yen (salary and research expenses), 2026.
- **Research RA in Value Exchange Engineering by RIISE@UTokyo**
2,000,000 yen, 2023-2024.
- **The foundation Matsuo Scholarship Society**
Scholarship and commuting expenses grant, free accommodation in student dormitories, provision of meals (free), health insurance expenses grant, total amount granted: approximately 5,000,000 yen, 2019-2023.

Academic Awards

- **Young Researcher Award (21/517)**
The 32nd Annual Meeting of the Association for Natural Language Processing@Japan, 2026.

- **Hatakeyama Prize**
  Tomakomai National Institute of Technology, 2019.

Languages

- **Japanese:** Native
- **English:** TOEFL iBT MyBest Score: 104

Programming Skills

- **Python:** PyTorch, Jax, Transformers, TRL, Ray
- **Others:** C++